

PokeTasks Gamified Features

Purpose Implementation and Future Applications

9 October 2026

PokeTasks adds playful progression to a serious task workflow. Choose work, focus, record progress and complete it; those actions earn XP and Coins and help a companion hatch, grow, evolve and join a collection. Linear owns the tasks and projects.

The aim is to make useful work easier to start and more satisfying to finish. Rewards acknowledge effort without judging personal worth. The benefits below are design reasoning, not measured outcomes from a PokeTasks user study.

The idea behind the system

The project moved from PokeTokenBar's AI usage companion toward Linear-connected task management. The companion now provides a reason to return to meaningful work. AI usage still supplies XP, explicitly as a secondary source. [\[L1\]](#)

The loop has three timescales: immediate reward feedback, a manageable focus session, and creature progression across days. A user can enjoy one layer without engaging deeply with the others.

The implemented loop: choose a Linear issue or local timer > focus and optionally check in > finish the session or complete the task > credit the applicable reward > update the wallet and companion > show feedback > save progress.

Today, Soon and Later, sub-issues, scheduling, notes and project views support the loop. Moving a card, expanding a project or scheduling a block does not itself earn XP. These planning features become part of gamification when real work connects to game progress. [\[L2, L3, L4\]](#)

Feature map

Feature family	Game element	Intended productivity role
Issue and project completion	XP awards and milestone bonuses	Give finished work a clear acknowledgement
Focus sessions	Time-based XP and completion multipliers	Make a bounded work period feel worthwhile
Check-ins and notes	Reflection with an overtime note bonus	Help the user notice drift and preserve context
Battle window	HP countdown and potion inventory	Turn a timer into a visible short challenge
Session ending choices	Complete, finish, continue and forfeit	Make decisions about stopping explicit
Desktop companion	Persistent pet, timer and folded Game Boy	Keep the chosen work easy to return to
Eggs and evolution	Discovery and staged growth	Make small actions contribute to a larger goal
Graduation and collection	Trophies, Pokédex and catch history	Preserve a visible record of accumulated progress
Storage and selection	One trainee and saved partners	Give choice without discarding earlier progress
Rarity and individual profiles	Shiny variants, forms and personality	Add discovery and attachment
Coins and Shop	Earned currency and item choices	Give rewards a purpose beyond a rising number
Rare Candy and Mint	Growth items and temporary boosts	Add agency over progression
Reward feedback	XP notices and celebrations	Make the cause and result of an action visible
Score and activity insights	XP total, measured time and heatmap	Support reflection and visible continuity
Difficulty and display preferences	Adjustable pacing and presentation	Let the system fit different work styles

These mechanics exist in the reviewed code. The v2.5 Battle display is merged; later changes such as its task chooser, shared display menus and stored-partner graduation handoff are local refinements. Themes and original creatures remain proposals. [L5, C1, C2, C3, C4, C5, C6, C7, C8]

Work rewards

Issue and project completion

Each newly credited Linear issue earns 2 million XP. A newly credited completed project earns 20 million XP, recognising a larger milestone. Rewards use the confirmed Linear completion path or a refresh that detects completion. The first successful poll records existing completed IDs without granting XP, and later polls use saved IDs to prevent ordinary repeat awards. This keeps onboarding from presenting old work as new achievement. [C1, C2]

Example: a cover-letter issue earns 2 million XP; the completed job-search project earns 20 million. Neither award varies with task estimates or priority.

Thinking and benefit: tasks receive a clear payoff, while a project receives stronger recognition and a sense of closure.

Future improvement: fixed issue rewards can favour splitting work into many small tasks. Optional milestones or simple effort bands could help. Larger workspaces also need a durable credit ledger: the current history retains 500 IDs and polling looks back 14 days, limiting historical deduplication and offline catch-up. [C1]

Focus sessions and completion bonuses

Session reward calculations use 1 million XP per complete 10-minute interval. A normal session finish pays the baseline rate. Eligible Linear completion while the session's five-times window remains open pays 5x planned-session XP, alongside the separate issue award. Entering overtime closes that window. Successfully posting a note can make overtime intervals worth 2x, including a top-up for eligible intervals already paid. Mint is an additional multiplier when it is active at credit time. [C2, C3]

Standalone local timers finish through the baseline session path and do not create a Linear issue award. The existing time-open XP setting also gates session XP. Focus and passive open-time awards share a daily cap of 144 million base XP; Mint is applied afterwards. These are implementation details worth explaining in the UI because they materially change the reward a user receives.

Thinking and benefit: a bounded session can feel achievable, and time rewards acknowledge unfinished work. The completion multiplier adds a finish target.

Future improvement: show a receipt for time, completion, Mint and caps. A five-minute session currently earns zero time XP; proportional credit could acknowledge short work. Reconsider the large completion multiplier for exploratory tasks. Separate passive-time and session-reward toggles so disabling idle credit does not disable focus rewards.

Check-ins and notes

The session can ask whether the user is still on task, with Yes, No and Skip answers and an optional note. A successful note is saved through the Linear comment flow and can activate the overtime note multiplier. A failed post does not earn that note-based top-up. The answer itself is not a separate XP award. Standalone timers do not post task notes to Linear. [C2, C3]

Thinking and benefit: check-ins help users notice drift. A short note preserves what was tried, what remains or what is blocking progress, making a later return easier.

Example: "Reproduced the click at the loop boundary; next step is checking the fade" preserves a return point while the issue stays open.

Future improvement: use one optional next-step prompt, avoiding incentives for comment spam. Allow local notes for standalone sessions. Treat "No" as a chance to change scope or pause.

The focus experience

Battle window and HP timer

The optional Battle window translates remaining focus time into an HP bar, alongside the companion's existing XP progress. HP reaches zero when time runs out and waits for a decision. Pause freezes the clock and sprite movement and mutes the display. The opponent artwork gives the session a game setting; the implementation does not calculate combat outcomes from attacks, Pokémon stats or task difficulty. [L6, C4]

Owned items add time: Potion 5 minutes, Super Potion 15, Hyper Potion 30, Revive 60, and Full Restore a custom whole-minute amount. The full effect must fit within the existing 180-minute total cap. Using an item while paused keeps the timer paused; using one at zero resumes it. A saved transaction journal supports recovery without consuming the same potion twice. [C2, C4]

Thinking and benefit: dwindling HP makes time tangible; items make an extension deliberate. Familiar game language can make the timer more inviting.

Future improvement: keep minutes visible beside HP and preserve ordinary time adjustment. Breaks and estimate corrections should remain simple choices. A boss-task variant could represent completed subtasks, but reaching zero must not automatically complete real work.



Installed PokeTasks v2.5 capture saved on 6 October 2026. The paused Battle shows native task context, remaining-time HP and companion growth XP.

Ending a session and returning later

Finishing a session and completing a Linear task are separate actions. The task can remain In Progress while tracked work is saved. Overtime allows continued work under different reward rules. Forfeit cancels pending session rewards, while previously earned XP and the unfinished task remain. Recorded active time is retained in the session ledger, including stopped and forfeited sessions. [C2, C3, C7]

Battle defers session rewards until settlement. Linear completion must succeed before settling; local completion uses baseline reward math. The live action says "Rest", but its handler finishes the task rather than taking a break, making clearer naming worthwhile. [C2, C4]

Thinking and benefit: explicit choices keep the user in control and preserve partial work for later review.

Future improvement: make "Stop and save progress" the ordinary exit. Separate task completion from a break. Explain any pending bonus loss without implying that work or earned collection progress was erased.

Companion and display modes

The companion can remain visible beside the task timer, providing a small reminder of the chosen work. Current local controls offer Classic, Battle and Timer Only modes with independent saved sizing. Battle can fold into a pixel Game Boy whose LCD uses the same live countdown. Folding changes presentation while the native session continues. Its task chooser reuses the native Linear issue cards and focus-duration flow. [C4, C8]

Thinking and benefit: nearby task context can make returning after distraction easier. The pet adds personality while the main planning window is closed.

Future improvement: offer quiet reactions, keyboard access and a comfortable Timer Only mode. Avoid suggesting that the companion suffers during time away or needs constant attention.

Companion progression

Eggs hatching growth and evolution

Earned XP enters one shared growth path. An egg progresses until it can hatch; an active companion progresses through its evolution stages and finally graduates. XP from focus or Linear work can trigger hatching without depending on a later AI-usage refresh. Growth above the hatch threshold carries into the hatched companion, and stage overflow carries into its next evolution stage. [C1]

At default growth difficulty, the egg threshold is 50,000 XP. Total growth through graduation is 7.5 million for Common, 18.75 million for Uncommon, 30 million for Rare and 60 million for Legendary. The total is distributed across the family's stages, with later stages requiring more XP. These are balance values, not estimates of how long someone should work. [C5]

Thinking and benefit: small actions contribute to visible growth. Hatching adds discovery and evolution supplies intermediate milestones.

Future improvement: calibrate growth around ordinary sessions. One eligible 25-minute Linear completion can award 12 million XP before Mint, exceeding a Common family's default total and skipping gradual growth. Tune milestones to useful sessions and preserve earned progress during balance changes.

Graduation trophies and collection history

Graduation stores the completed individual as a trophy in the Pokédex. The collection can show discovered species, while Catch log keeps individual history, including rarity, shiny state, nature, date and evolution path. Individual records and a species-level catalogue answer different questions: "Which kinds have I discovered?" and "Which companions have I raised?" [L7, C1]

Thinking and benefit: trophies give training an ending and make accumulated progress visible beyond a temporary notification.

Future improvement: optionally link a trophy to a project: "Raised while finishing my portfolio." Keep descriptions editable and unknown dates honest. Collection count should not rank effort or worth.

Storage swapping and representative selection

One companion trains at a time. Storage holds eggs and unfinished partners with their saved progress. Buying an egg places it in Storage while the current partner keeps training. An explicit Train action swaps the active slot and preserves the outgoing trainee. Choosing a representative changes the display identity without swapping training or starting focus. [L7, C1]

The current local graduation refinement resumes the first stored partner before falling back to a free unguaranteed egg. Stored eggs are skipped by that automatic partner handoff. This reuses existing unfinished progress rather than continually creating new training starts.

Thinking and benefit: users can change their goal without discarding earlier progress. One trainee keeps the immediate target simple.

Future improvement: offer an ordered training queue or a choice at graduation. Make handoff predictable and show the actual trainee before applying items.

Rarity variants and individual identity

Discovery includes Common, Uncommon, Rare and Legendary categories, shiny variants, Unown forms and occasional Ditto disguise reveals. Default shiny odds are 1 in 64, improved to 1 in 48 by owning Shiny Charm. The Ditto disguise roll is 1 in 128 for eligible Common families with multiple forms. Normal duplicate ownership is checked across active, stored and collected companions, with shiny and form-aware rules. [C1, C5]

Individuals have persisted identity, nature, gender, IVs, abilities and moves where available. Levels grow from 5 toward 100. These enrich the creature; Battle HP still represents time, not calculated combat health. [C5, C6]

Thinking and benefit: discovery and individuality add curiosity and attachment to a repeated routine.

Future improvement: explain chance and offer deterministic goals. Original creatures could use simpler personality, lore and growth profiles. The existing proposal starts with a pilot family and a recoverable legacy archive. [L8]

Economy and feedback

Coins Shop and item choices

Earned wallet XP becomes Coins at 1 Coin per 1,000 XP, rounded down. Available Coins equal that earned amount minus previous spending. Spending does not reduce lifetime XP or undo creature growth. Rare Candy growth is a separate exception: consuming it advances a companion but does not mint more wallet XP or Coins. [C1, C5]

Product	Default price in Coins	Effect
Mint	1,000	2x incoming XP for 30 minutes
Rare Candy	5,000	1.5 million growth XP
Standard Egg	10,000	Stored egg without a rarity guarantee
Uncommon Egg	25,000	Stored egg guaranteeing Uncommon or better

Product	Default price in Coins	Effect
Shiny Charm	30,000	Permanent improvement to future shiny odds
Rare Egg	40,000	Stored egg guaranteeing Rare or better
Focus potions	100 to 3,600	Add preset or custom minutes

Prices change with shop difficulty. Passive Shiny Charm is purchased once. The normal catalogue supports quantity selection for consumables with balance and ownership checks; buying is separate from using. Egg tiers guarantee a rarity floor, not a specific species. [C1, C5]

Thinking and benefit: spending gives users a choice between discovery, growth and boosts.

Future improvement: preview the remaining balance and practical effect, including sessions needed to afford an item. Keep shopping brief. Coins are local game currency, not money or a productivity measure.

Rare Candy Mint and usage rewards

Rare Candy adds 1.5 million growth XP; a batch preview accounts for evolution and preserves unused candies. It receives no Mint multiplier or wallet credit. Mint doubles incoming XP for 30 minutes without changing nature or identity. Its effect depends on credit time, not exactly when the work happened. [C1, C5]

AI tokens convert 1 to 1 into XP after the usage baseline. There is also refresh-driven passive open-time XP, nominally 1 million per 10 minutes, with limited catch-up and the shared daily cap. Passive awards are suspended while a focus session owns the clock. Despite older comments calling this growth-only, the current accounting credits bonus wallet XP as well. Provider limit crossings can grant Rare Candy: generally one for a session window and five for a weekly window. [C1, C5]

Thinking and benefit: inherited activity rewards and boosts support progress outside task completion.

Future improvement: make token and idle rewards visibly secondary. Neither proves useful work. Consider passive credit off by default and neutral quota notices so resource consumption does not become a target.

XP notices and celebrations

Actual positive rewards produce visible feedback: teal for background earnings, green for issue or project completion and purple for Rare Candy. Menu-bar text, a badge near the companion, speech bubbles and a screen-edge effect connect the action to its result. Hatching, evolution and graduation have their own reactions. [L9, C1]

The XP controller shows a notice for three seconds, combines frequent background notices at most every 30 seconds, and prioritises completion and candy notices. It does not create rewards, replay them on launch or show zero-value baseline awards. Reduced Motion and Low Power Mode retain static reward text while removing movement and the edge pulse. [L9, C8]

Thinking and benefit: useful actions receive visible acknowledgement; batching limits interruptions.

Future improvement: allow quiet text and an exact receipt on demand. Distinguish a card's base award from the actual Mint-adjusted reward; stored issue records currently retain the base amount.

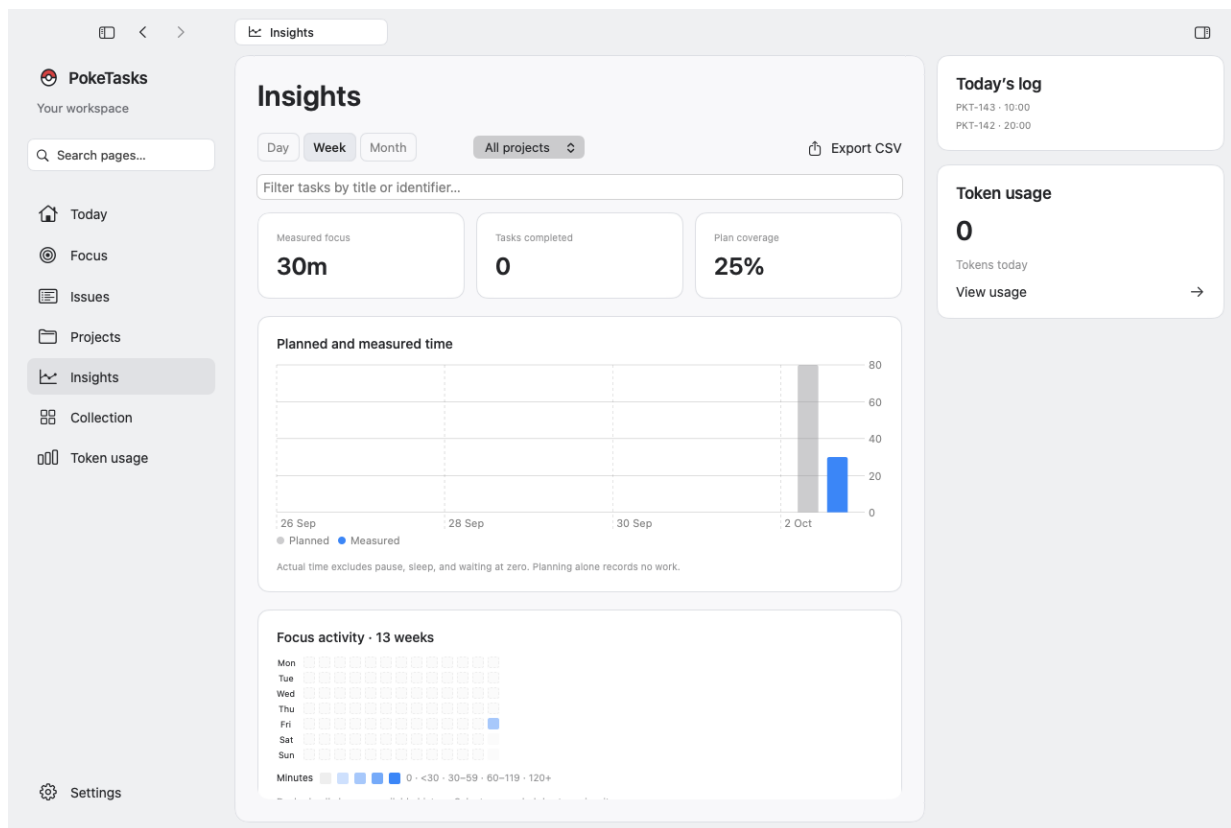
Score measured work and activity heatmap

The work-surface Score is lifetime wallet XP. It includes work rewards, token XP, passive credit and applicable boosts. It is therefore a game-progress total, not a validated productivity score. Today also exposes completed work and session logs. Insights separates measured focus time, distinct completed tasks, planned time, plan coverage and session XP. [C1, C7, C8]

The activity heatmap uses 13 week columns and seven weekday rows, with intensity based on measured focus minutes. Session records retain active segments and split them by local date. Pauses, sleep and waiting at zero add no measured focus time. Partial legacy durations can remain in recorded totals but are excluded from measured charts and coverage. Plan coverage caps linked work at each block's planned duration; no plan means no coverage score. [L10, C7]

Thinking and benefit: activity history makes scattered work visible and supports realistic planning. Time, finished tasks and XP answer different questions.

Future improvement: call Score "Lifetime XP". Keep rest days neutral and missing history distinct from zero. Add reflection without streak penalties or rankings; darker cells do not mean better decisions.



Native Insights fixture preview with illustrative data. Focus minutes, completed tasks and plan coverage remain separate; the activity grid shows measured work.

Difficulty and personalisation

Growth difficulty and shop difficulty can be adjusted independently from 0.1x to 2x. Growth changes rescale progress to preserve the existing fraction rather than simply wiping it. Display mode, size, representative selection and notification preferences also let users choose how prominent the game should be. [C1, C5, C8]

Thinking and benefit: adjustable pacing fits different workloads and tastes.

Future improvement: describe pacing as useful sessions per milestone. Themes remain an appearance proposal with unlockable themes deferred; original creatures remain a proposed replacement. Neither is a shipped reward feature. [L8, L11]

Worked examples

The following calculations use default settings, no Mint, sufficient cap remaining, enabled session XP and newly creditable Linear work. They show nominal reward math; they are not measured productivity results.

Finishing a 25 minute Linear task

Two complete 10-minute intervals are eligible. Ordinary session settlement is 2 million XP. Eligible five-times Linear completion instead pays 10 million session XP, plus 2 million issue XP, totalling 12 million XP or 12,000 newly earned Coins. The final five minutes do not add another interval. That is enough for a standard 10,000-Coin egg with 2,000 Coins left from this award. Buying stores the egg without replacing the current partner.

This example also exposes the pacing issue: 12 million XP exceeds the Common family's 7.5-million default graduation total. A future task-based balance should deliberately decide how many milestones one ordinary session should pass. [C1, C3, C5]

Doing useful work without finishing the issue

After 30 active minutes, choosing the normal finish-and-leave-In-Progress path settles 3 million XP, subject to the shared cap, and retains 30 minutes of measured work. It does not award the issue's 2 million completion XP or change it to Done. A forfeit retains the measured time but does not pay that pending settlement. This is why the stopping choices need clear names. [C2, C3, C7]

Extending a paused Battle session

Using one owned Super Potion adds 15 minutes if its full effect fits the cap, consumes one item, and keeps the timer paused. HP and the displayed planned duration update from the native timer state. A save interruption recovers the extension as paused and uses the transaction identity to avoid a second item charge. [C2, C4]

Reviewing a plan without chasing XP

Two 30-minute blocks create a 60-minute plan. If one records 45 linked minutes and the other 15, capped coverage is $30 + 15 = 45$ minutes, or 75%. Measured work is still 60 minutes. XP remains a separate value. The result suggests reviewing the second block; it does not say the extra first-block effort was wasted. [C7]

What the productivity reasoning can support

Ryan and Deci's framework discusses competence, autonomy and relatedness and distinguishes self-directed motivation from external control. Applying it here suggests visible progress, choice and freedom from guilt. This is an interpretation; a virtual companion does not demonstrate satisfaction of human relatedness needs. [R1]

Mekler and colleagues found increased output quantity in an image-annotation task using points, levels and leaderboards, without significantly increased intrinsic motivation or competence. More rewarded actions need not mean better work; the same effect has not been established in PokeTasks. [R2]

Sailer and Homner found positive learning effects, with motivational and behavioural findings less stable in stricter study subsets. Those educational results support further testing, not proven benefits in professional task management. [R3]

Albulescu and colleagues found micro-break benefits for vigour and fatigue, but no statistically significant overall performance effect. Welcoming breaks is reasonable; claiming they always improve task output would exceed the evidence. [R4]

Better directions for future updates

Priority	Change	Why it comes first
First	Explain every reward and rename Score where needed	Users should understand XP, Coins, measured time and caps
First	Make stopping and taking a break clear and supportive	Preserve partial work and prevent ambiguous Rest or Forfeit actions
First	Separate passive, token and focus reward controls	Let task-first users choose what drives progression
Next	Calibrate growth and Shop around ordinary work sessions	Prevent instant milestones and rewards dominated by token volume
Next	Add quiet feedback and deliberate collection goals	Support users who dislike pulses, chance or collecting everything
Next	Strengthen the reward ledger and catch-up policy	Keep credit understandable across long histories and offline periods
Later	Link trophies to projects and introduce original creatures	Give progress personal meaning while preserving old saves

These recommendations are not approved release scope. Start with a reward receipt and ordinary-session pacing review before adding quests or currencies. Reuse the current stores and accounting.

For original creatures, the existing plan starts with one two-stage family and then five families. Carry financial balances and work-credit history forward once, preserve the old collection in a recoverable archive, and define what happens to stored eggs and rarity guarantees. Replacing art alone would leave identity and progression problems unresolved. [L8]

Alternatives for other apps and use cases

Use case	Adapted game idea	Reward a useful signal	Keep in view
Study and coursework	A growing library or expedition map	A completed study block and a short recall exercise	Time spent does not prove understanding
Audio and creative production	A studio habitat or companion album	A saved draft, reviewed revision or delivered milestone	Exploration and discarded experiments can be useful work
Household tasks	A shared garden or restored room	User-confirmed chores and maintenance steps	Make contributions fair without household rankings
Habit and routine apps	A creature that develops gradually	Completing a chosen routine at a sustainable frequency	Include rest days and make returning after a gap easy
Team project management	A shared expedition with milestone celebrations	Confirmed team outcomes and cooperative contributions	Avoid ranking people by ticket counts or hours
Research and deep work	An expedition journal with discoveries	A focus block plus a finding, question or next step	A useful negative result still deserves acknowledgement
Minimal professional tools	Quiet progress receipts or a milestone shelf	A completed task, milestone or saved work session	Keep the same loop usable without pets or game language

These are adaptations of the mechanics, not claims about existing integrations. The underlying event can stay the same while its representation changes: XP becomes growth rings, Coins become optional decoration credits, a Pokédex becomes a milestone archive, and HP becomes a visible session budget.

For teams, begin with cooperative goals, optional participation and private personal focus data. Ticket volume varies by role and cannot fairly rank contribution.

Creative work can reward useful checkpoints; routines can celebrate returning after a gap. A minimal app may need only calm acknowledgement and history, without a collection or economy.

How to judge whether it helps

Judge time from task selection to starting, meaningful completion, return after interruption and preservation of partial work. Ask whether the person felt supported or pressured. Longer sessions, more tokens and Shop visits are not success criteria themselves.

A small optional trial could compare a quiet timer period with a companion period over several weeks, keeping workload and notifications similar. Review experience and whether novelty fades. Changing tasks and circumstances limit causal conclusions.

Before accounting changes ship, check single credit per event, failed Linear writes, local-only timers and measured-time exclusions. Check cap/Mint receipts, short sessions, potion recovery, storage and balance migration. Verify readable static feedback. These checks protect reward integrity, not productivity claims.

Project references

L1 [PokeTasks project brief](#).

L2 [UI Overhaul v2](#).

L3 [Today Soon and Later](#).

L4 [Time Blocking](#).

L5 [Progress update on 9 October 2026](#).

L6 [Battle window PER-294 and PR 11](#).

L7 [Collection Pokédex and Bag](#).

L8 [Original Creature Replacement Plan](#) is historical future-direction material.

L9 [Motion and Animation Outline](#).

L10 [Time Tracking Scores and Heatmap](#).

L11 [Themes Proposal](#).

See also [Focus and Floating Timer](#) and [Implementation and Validation](#). Feature documents remain the owners of implementation decisions.

Implementation references

Sources refer to the local `experiments/PokeTasks-v3` tree at merged commit `e2ff6eb2` plus local refinements. Executable accounting takes precedence over older token-era comments.

Reference	Source in the PokeTaskBar module	Main responsibility
C1	<code>Core/CompanionStore.swift</code> and <code>Core/LinearClient.swift</code>	Reward crediting, growth, wallet, storage and completion history
C2	<code>Core/FocusSessionStore.swift</code>	Session lifecycle, Linear completion, notes and potion transactions
C3	<code>Core/FocusSession.swift</code> and <code>Core/TimeOpenXP.swift</code>	Interval math, multipliers, clock states and passive-time cap
C4	<code>UI/BattleWindow.swift</code> and <code>Core/FocusPotion.swift</code>	Native Battle state and timer extensions
C5	<code>Core/CompanionModel.swift</code> and <code>Core/EconomyScale.swift</code>	Balance values, rarity, item effects and XP-to-Coin conversion
C6	<code>Core/PokemonProfile.swift</code>	Individual attributes and normalized level progression
C7	<code>Core/TaskTime.swift</code> and <code>UI/TaskInsightsView.swift</code>	Session reports, distinct completions and plan coverage
C8	<code>Core/XPFeedback.swift</code> , <code>UI/ScoreBoard.swift</code> and <code>UI/FloatingDisplayMenu.swift</code>	Reward presentation, lifetime Score and current local display choices

Research references

R1 Ryan and Deci 2000. [Intrinsic and Extrinsic Motivations](#).

R2 Mekler and colleagues 2017. [Individual gamification elements motivation and performance](#).

R3 Sailer and Homner 2020. [The Gamification of Learning](#).

R4 Albulescu and colleagues 2022. [Give me a break](#).